

scripts/check-no-nested-own-org-submodules.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-05-15 (constitution-compliance plan Phase 5)

Inheritance: HelixConstitution §11.4.28 (Submodules-As-Equal-Codebase)
+ §11.4.18 (script docs)

Overview

Enforces §11.4.28: an owned-by-us submodule MUST NOT itself contain another own-org submodule as a nested entry. Chains like vasic-digital/Lava → vasic-digital/Challenges → vasic-digital/Panoptic are forbidden — they create transitive-ownership opacity, frustrate independent peer development, and silently couple component lifecycles that §11.4.28 demands be peers.

Forbidden orgs

The OWN-ORG set (any of these orgs as a nested submodule's host org triggers a violation):

- vasic-digital
- HelixDevelopment
- red-elf
- ATMOSphere1234321
- Bear-Suite
- BoatOS123456
- Helix-Flow
- Helix-Track
- Server-Factory

Both github.com: and gitlab.com: URL forms are matched.

Modes

Flag	Behavior
<code>--strict</code> (default)	Exit 1 on any violation
<code>--advisory</code>	Exit 0 even on violation
<code>LAVA_NESTED_OWN_ORG_STRICT=0</code> env	Same as <code>--advisory</code>

Resolution paths

When a violation is reported, two resolution paths exist:

1. **Refactor (preferred):** Extract the nested submodule to be a peer of the container. Example: move `submodules/challenges/Panoptic` to `submodules/Panoptic` (parent-level peer of `submodules/challenges`). Both submodules then load independently from the parent project's `.gitmodules`.
2. **Waiver:** Add an entry to the `WAIVERS=()` array at the top of the scanner. Each waiver **MUST** cite:
 - WHY the nesting exists (legacy coupling, hard infrastructure dependency, etc.)
 - Tracking issue or commit referencing the planned refactor
 - Target removal date or "permanent" if structurally required

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-no-nested-own-org-submodules.sh
# strict (default)
bash scripts/check-no-nested-own-org-submodules.sh --advisory
# exit 0 even on violation
LAVA_NESTED_OWN_ORG_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-no-nested-own-org-
submodules.sh # env-driven
```

Hermetic test

`tests/check-constitution/test_nested_own_org_submodules.sh` — 4 fixtures:

- `test_clean_fixture_passes` — synthetic `submodules/foo/` pointing to `nlohmann/json` (third-party org) → exits 0
- `test_vasic_digital_chain_rejected` — synthetic `vasic-digital` chain → exits 1 with violation

- `test_helix_dev_gitlab_chain_rejected` — HelixDevelopment via gitlab → exits 1 with violation
- `test_advisory_mode_returns_zero` — advisory mode swallows exit code

Known violations (2026-05-15 audit)

Container	Nested path	Forbidden URL	Status
submodules/ challenges	Panoptic	git@github.com:vasic-digital/Panoptic.git	OPEN — refactor owed

The Challenges/Panoptic chain pre-dates §11.4.28 (the clause was added 2026-05-15). Resolution is owed in a follow-up cycle: extract Panoptic to be submodules/Panoptic (parent-level peer of Challenges), update both projects' `.gitmodules`, propagate the rename through any references in the Challenges submodule's code.

Cross-references

- HelixConstitution Constitution.md §11.4.28 (the mandate)
- docs/plans/2026-05-15-constitution-compliance.md Phase 5
- docs/helix-constitution-gates.md CM-NO-NESTED-OWN-ORG-SUBMODULES row
- scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh (wraps this scanner per §11.4.32)